

GEOGRAPHY

PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY



CLIMATOLOGY

MODULE – 41

WORLD CLIMATIC TYPES
THE BRITISH CLIMATE

(PART- 2)

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT



1 A very large part of the deciduous woodlands have been cleared for fuel, timber or agriculture.

2 A large range of cereals, fruits and root crops are raised, mainly for home consumption rather than for export.

3 North-West Europe, which includes some of the most crowded parts of the globe, has little surplus for export.

4 It is, in fact, a net importer of food crops, especially wheat from almost all parts of the wheat lands for bread-making and other food items.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT



5 The region differs from many others in its **unprecedented industrial advancement**.

6 The countries are concerned in the production of **machinery, chemicals, textiles and other manufactured articles** rather than agriculture, fishing, or lumbering, though these activities are well represented in some of the countries.

7 Fishing is particularly important in Britain, Norway and British Columbia.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 1

MARKET GARDENING



1

Though market gardening is practiced throughout the world wherever there is a large urban population, nowhere else is it so highly specialized as in North-West Europe.

WHAT IS MARKET GARDENING?

- *A market garden is the relatively small-scale production of fruits, vegetables and flowers as cash crops, frequently sold directly to consumers and restaurants.*
- *The diversity of crops grown on a small area of land, typically, from under one acre to a few acres, or sometimes in greenhouses distinguishes it from other types of farming.*

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

MARKET GARDENING

TYPE- 1

- 2 Several factors account for this. All the North-Western European countries (Britain, France, West Germany, Benelux and Denmark) are **highly industrialized and have high population densities**.
- 3 There are **more towns and cities than in other continents despite its small size**. It is understandable that the demand for fresh vegetables, green salads, eggs, meat, milk and fruits will be tremendous.
- 4 As the items are perishable, a good network of transport is indispensable.
- 5 The produce such as lettuces, cabbages, cauliflowers, tomatoes, onions, peas and fruits are seldom shipped but conveyed by **high-speed conveyances such as trucks or vans**.
- 6 Perhaps, a more appropriate term to use is **truck farming**, which is commonly used in the United States.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

MARKET GARDENING

TYPE- 1



7

Similarly, bulbs and flowers from the the Netherlands and eggs, bacon and other dairy products from Denmark are sent to most of the major industrial centres of Europe in almost perfect condition for household consumption.

8

The horticultural industry in the Netherlands is so highly specialized that Dutch tulips and bulbs are flown by the K.L.M. (Dutch Airlines) to Rome, Paris, Zurich, and London.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

MARKET GARDENING

TYPE- 1



9

In Australia, **high-speed boats** ply across the **Bass Strait** daily from Tasmania to rush vegetables, tomatoes, apples and beans to most of the large cities in mainland Australia.

10

It is no wonder the Australians nicknamed Tasmania the 'garden state'.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 2

MIXED FARMING

- 1 Throughout Britain and north-western Europe, farmers practise both arable farming (cultivation of crops on ploughed land) and pastoral farming (keeping animals on grass meadows).
- 2 Crops may be raised for cash sales or as fodder for cattle or sheep.
- 3 The proportion of crops and animals in the farm at any time depends to a great extent on the **type of soil, the price of the cereals and the demand for animals and animal products.**
- 4 The farmers also plant a few fruit trees (apples, pears, plums), rear pigs, keep poultry, mainly for eggs, and even have bees for honey.
- 5 There is such a great variety in the farms that the **term mixed farming is most aptly applied.**

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 2

MIXED FARMING



6

Amongst the cereals, **wheat** is the most extensively grown, almost entirely for home consumption because of the very dense population in north-western Europe.

7

At one time, some of the European countries (**France, Denmark and the Netherlands**) used to be **wheat exporters**, but the keen competition from the new wheat-lands of the New World forced most of the farmers to divert their interest to other more profitable uses of their land such as **market gardening, dairying** or an intensive form of mixed farming.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 2

MIXED FARMING



8 The next most important cereal raised in the mixed farm is **barley**.

9 The most important animals kept in the mixed farm are **cattle**.

10 North-western Europe was originally the home of many world renowned cattle breeds, e.g. **Guernsey, Ayrshire and Friesian**, which are first class dairy cattle for milk production.

11 Europeans drink more milk than anybody else except the New Zealanders.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 2

MIXED FARMING

- 12** In the United Kingdom, a person drink almost a pint of milk a day! From milk, other important dairy products are derived.



- 13** These are butter, cheese, cream, and skimmed milk or casein, a raw material for making plastics, paper and drugs.

- 14** The temperate western margin type of climate is almost **ideal for intensive dairying**.

- 15** Fresh milk is converted into various forms of condensed or evaporated milk, and exported around the world **for baby-feeding, confectionery, ice-cream and chocolate making**.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

MIXED FARMING

TYPE- 2



BACON

16 In the mixed in farms in Europe, farmers keep cattle also with a view of enriching their fields with the animal dung.

17 The pigs and poultry act as scavengers that feed on the left-overs from root-crops and dairy-processes.

18 In this way, Denmark is able to export large quantities of bacon from pigs that are fed on the skimmed milk, a by-product of butter-making.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 3

SHEEP REARING



LEICESTER SHEEP

- 1 This is well developed in some parts of British type of climate.
- 2 Britain is the home of some of the best known sheep breeds, e.g. Leicester, Lincolns and Southdowns which are dual-purpose, noted for mutton as well as wool.
- 3 With the greater pressure exerted on land by increased urbanization, industrialization and agriculture, sheep rearing is being pushed further and further into the less favoured areas.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 3

SHEEP REARING



4

In the southern hemisphere , **sheep rearing is the chief occupation of New Zealand**, with its greatest concentration in the Canterbury Plain.

5

Many factors have led to this unprecedented growth during the past century including **extensive meadows, a mild temperate climate, well-drained level ground, scientific animal breeding, and last, but most vital, the development of refrigeration.**

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THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

OTHER AGRICULTURAL ACTIVITIES

TYPE- 4



- 1 Apart from market gardening and mixed farming which have been singled out for greater individual treatment, the British type of climate also supports a number of other important crops.
- 2 Amongst the food crops, **potatoes** feature prominently in the domestic economy of the cool temperate regions.
- 3 It is the **staple food** in supplementing **wheat or bread** for millions of people.
- 4 In terms of starch, it yields far more food than any cereals and can be cultivated over a wide range of climatic and soil types.

6

THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

OTHER AGRICULTURAL ACTIVITIES

TYPE- 4



POTATO BLIGHT

- 5 But normally a cooler and more northerly latitude is preferred because the crop will be less prone to the attack of 'blight', a virus disease that is particularly infectious in warm and humid countries.
- 6 Besides its principal use as a substitute for bread, large quantities of potatoes are also consumed as animal fodder and as a source of industrial alcohol.
- 7 Another interesting crop that is found almost exclusively in north-western Europe (including European U.S.S.R.) and parts of U.S.A is beet sugar.

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THE COOL TEMPERATE WESTERN MARGIN (BRITISH TYPE) CLIMATE

ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

TYPE- 4

OTHER AGRICULTURAL ACTIVITIES



8 The need for such a crop was greatly felt during the Napoleonic Wars around 1800 when military blockades caused a scarcity of sugar.

9 High prices of imported tropical sugar (from cane sugar) drove many Governments of the temperate lands to think seriously about the vital importance of securing a certain amount self-sufficiency in their requirements.

10 The beet is crushed for sugar and the green tops are used as animal fodder.

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